

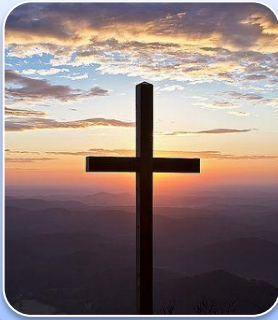
THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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Our Theme: THE SATISFIED LIFE OF THE BELIEVER

- Discovering and living a life that is fulfilled, satisfied and has a strong sense of completeness.
- The kind of satisfaction that gives a strong sense of safety and security and wellbeing.
- There is such a thing as a satisfied life, a life that every believer feels satisfied and fulfilled.

1. THE PATHWAY TO A CONTENTED AND SATISFIED LIFE.

* **NOTE:** That every believer must be fully aware of the relationship they already have with Christ as a result of God establishing it through the death and resurrection of Jesus Christ and the believer being born again by the Holy Spirit.

* It is from this relationship with Christ that the satisfied life originates.

* **NOTE:** That this relationship in which our satisfaction and fulfillment comes from is one of LOVE. It is a love relationship in which we share in God's love for us and we respond by loving him.

* *He loves first – we love because he first loved us.*

* *Nothing is able to separate us from the Love of God.*

Romans 8:39 No power in the sky above or in the earth below—indeed, nothing in all creation will ever be able to separate us from the love of God that is revealed in Christ Jesus our Lord. NLT

* It is this satisfied life that produces strong sense of safety, security, confidence in the believer.

* It also adds an overwhelming sense of worth and value to the believer's life.

* It is a kind of relationship that excels any relationship that this present world offers.

2. THE BELIEVERS' CHALLENGE.

* That every believer who desires to experience a fulfilled and satisfied life that they see to deepen their relationship and fellowship with Christ Jesus.

* **Another part of us experiencing the fulfilled life is to make Christ the central person of our lives because this gives to us a clearer picture of the quality and worth of that union or relationship that we have with Christ through the new birth - (John 3)**

* **Christ** is before all things and has the supremacy in all things and he is the head of the church, the beginning and the firstborn from the dead.

Colossians 1:17-18

17 he is before all things, and in him all things hold together. 18 and he is the head of the body, the church; he is the beginning and the firstborn from among the dead, so that in everything he might have the supremacy. NIV

* Being more sensitive to Christ's desires is also a part of the pathway to a satisfied life where what he wants become more than what we want.

* Where his mandate and the gospel's take priority over our desires, aspirations and plans.

* **Therefore, the believer needs to regularly self-test how they are progressing in making Christ first in their daily routine and what they can deliberately do to improve that process.**

3. THE BELIEVER'S GIVING AND GENEROSITY IS ALSO A PART OF THE PATHWAY TO EXPERIENCING THE SENSE OF ACCOMPLISHMENT AND CONTENTMENT.

- **DID YOU KNOW THAT WE DO NOT LOSE WHAT WE GIVE - BUT WE GAIN?**
- **THIS IS ALSO TRUE ABOUT MANY THINGS IN LIFE.**

The scripture states Proverbs 11:24 *"It is possible to give away and become richer! It is also possible to hold on too tightly and lose everything. TLB*

Proverbs 11:24 *There is that scattereth, and yet increaseth; and there is that withholdeth more than is meet, but it tendeth to poverty. KJV*

- So, in our **SCATTERING** or **GIVING** something away for the right purposes we do not lose, we gain; **but in withholding (keeping for ourselves) more than is necessary** only leads to **POVERTY**.

- **IT IS IN LOSING THAT WE MULTIPLY AND THIS IS WHAT JESUS TAUGHT** In the Gospels.
- **LOSING OUR LIFE** is not about losing our physical life (dying) but about making certain choices for our lives **that will result in us finding or discovering the real meaning of life or satisfied living.**

Mark 8:32-35

32 *And he spake that saying openly. And Peter took him, and began to rebuke him.*

33 *But when he had turned about and looked on his disciples, he rebuked Peter, saying, Get thee behind me, Satan: for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but the things that be of men. (Loving the wrong things).*

34 *And when he had called the people unto him with his disciples also, he said unto them, Whosoever will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.*

35 *For whosoever will save his life shall lose it; but whosoever shall LOSE HIS LIFE FOR MY SAKE and THE GOSPEL'S, THE SAME SHALL SAVE IT.*

- **LOSING OUR LIFE** is not about losing our physical life (dying) but about making certain choices for our lives **that will result in us finding or discovering the real meaning of life or satisfied living.**
- **IT IS ABOUT THAT INNER PART OF US THAT INVOLVES THE MIND THE WILL AND THE EMOTIONS.**
 - * **LOSING OUR LIFE** means letting GO something TO gain something more real, satisfying and fulfilling.
 - * **LETTING GO (saying goodbye to)** those things LIKE **OUR ASPIRATIONS, DREAMS, IDEAS AND PLANS FOR OUR LIFE** that we have spent our whole life trying to keep (hold on to).
 - * **IT IS IN LOSING THOSE THINGS that we gain** something that brings true and real contentment to our life and living.
 - * **IT IS GAINING SOMETHING THAT FULFILLS THE REAL PURPOSE FOR WHICH WE WERE MADE (created).**
 - * **IT FILLS THAT VOID / EMPTINESS that is in** every person born into this world.
 - * **THIS EMPTINESS** is the result of **SIN** entering through Adam's disobedience and thus constituting us as sinners.
- **Note: MUCH OF WHAT WE TODAY CALL "LIVING" IS NOTHING MORE THAN MERE EXISTING, SURVIVING. IT IS NOT 'LIFE' and HOW God made man in the beginning.**
 - * **HE MADE MAN to live in such a way that he would experience fulfillment, satisfaction and a sense of completeness.**
- **AND THIS IS HOW THE BELIEVER IN CHRIST IS MEANT TO LIVE.**

IMPORTANT TO NOTE:

- **THE WORD HERE FOR "LIFE"** in the Greek language in which the New Testament was written is **"PSUCHE"** or **"SOUL LIFE"**.
It is that part of our lives where we **DESIRE, PLAN, AND ASPIRE TO CERTAIN THINGS.**
 - **WHEN WE ARE PREPARED TO LOSE OUR PSUCHE- SOUL LIFE, SET ASIDE OUR PLANS, DESIRES, ASPIRATIONS, DREAMS FOR THE SAKE OF CHRIST AND THE GOSPELS', THEN WE WILL FIND (discover) TRUE LIFE AS IT WAS ORIGINALLY INTENDED TO BE – BY OUR MAKER/CREATOR.**
 - **WE WILL FIND FULFILLMENT, A SENSE OF COMPLETENESS AND WELLBEING.**
 - **WHEN WE LOSE OUR LIVES FOR THE WELFARE OF CHRIST AND OTHERS, WE WILL FIND IT. THIS IS THE KEY TO A FULFILLED (FILLED-FULL) LIFE.**
 - **WE WERE NOT MADE TO BE SELFISH BUT TO BE GENEROUS, KIND, LOVING AND CARING ETC.**
 - **WE WERE DESIGNED TO BE A REFLECTION OF OUR CREATOR AND HEAVENLY FATHER.**
 - **Let us all seek to experience in our own lives the pathway of FINDING LIFE through losing it for the sake of Christ and others.**
 - **THIS IS AN IMPORTANT MESSAGE – applicable for our entire life.**
- Amen – Ps Barry